

Types of Blood Vessels

Blood vessels are tube-like structures that carry blood throughout the body. They are an important part of the circulatory system. There are three main types of blood vessels: arteries, veins, and capillaries.

1. Arteries

- Arteries carry blood away from the heart.
- Most arteries carry oxygen-rich blood.
- Their walls are thick and elastic because blood flows with high pressure.
- Example: Aorta.

2. Veins

- Veins carry blood towards the heart.
- Most veins carry oxygen-poor blood.
- Veins have valves to prevent backflow of blood.
- Example: Vena cava.

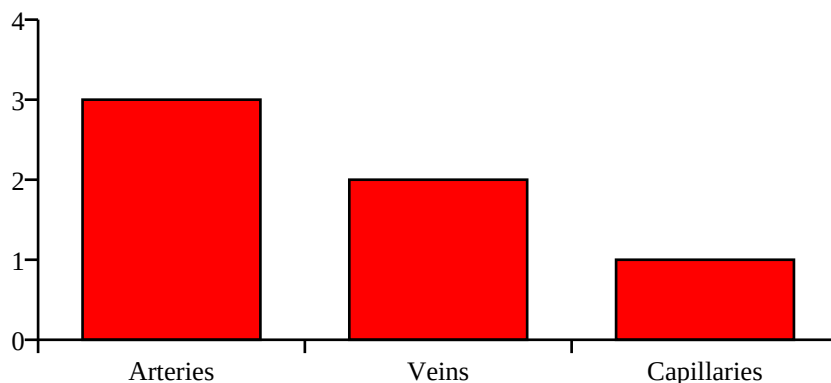
3. Capillaries

- Capillaries are very tiny blood vessels.
- They connect arteries and veins.
- Exchange of oxygen, nutrients, and waste materials takes place here.
- Their walls are extremely thin.

Comparison of Blood Vessels:

Feature	Arteries	Veins	Capillaries
Direction	Away from heart	Towards heart	Connect arteries & veins
Wall	Thick	Thin	Very thin
Pressure	High	Low	Very low
Valves	Absent	Present	Absent

Relative Thickness of Blood Vessel Walls:



Conclusion:

Blood vessels play a major role in transporting blood throughout the body. Arteries, veins, and capillaries work together to supply oxygen and nutrients and remove waste materials efficiently.